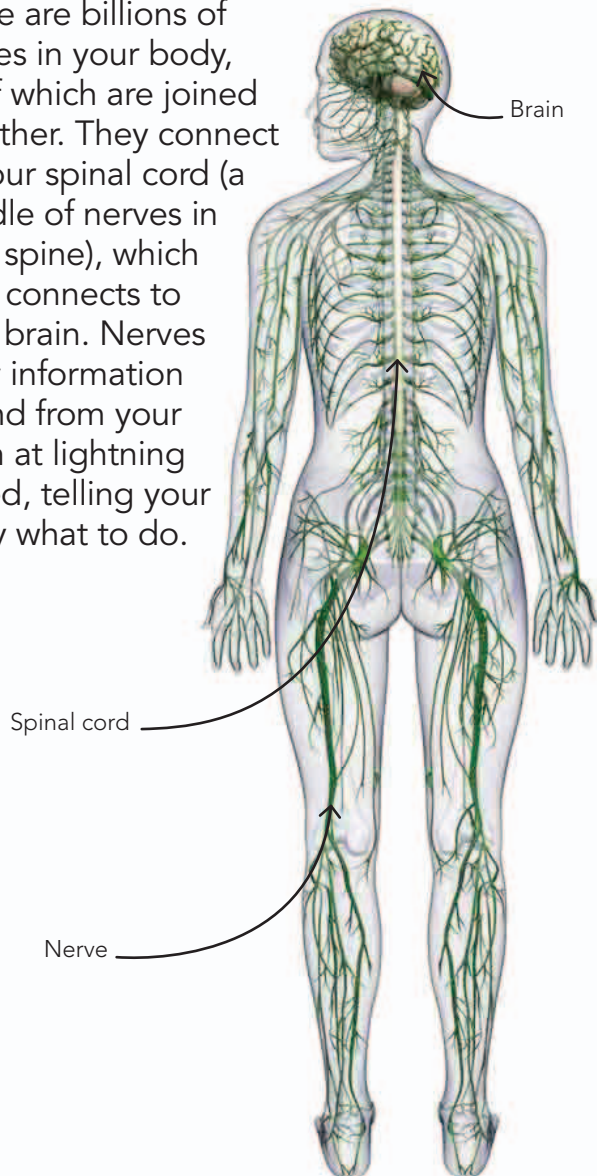


Why am I ticklish?

You feel ticklish because your skin is full of tiny touch sensors. When something touches you, these touch sensors send signals along nerves to your brain. A tickle can feel nice, but if it is too hard, it can become painful and your brain will send a message to your body to move away.

The nervous system

There are billions of nerves in your body, all of which are joined together. They connect to your spinal cord (a bundle of nerves in your spine), which then connects to your brain. Nerves carry information to and from your brain at lightning speed, telling your body what to do.



Skin sensors . . .

Billions of sensors in your skin help your brain to decide if things you touch feel cold or hot, smooth or sharp, pleasant or dangerous.

A pain signal travels from your toe to your brain in a fraction of a second.